

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

April

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

ASB	Alternative Service Book 1980 (Church of England)
CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
F	Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SA	An Anglican Prayer Book (Church of the Province of Southern Africa) 1989
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J M Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

2 APRIL

Gilbert of Caithness, Bishop (1245) [6] *White*

Gilbert de Moravia appears to have been a member of the family of the Lords of Duffus in Moray. He was for many years Archdeacon of Moray, and in 1223 was elected Bishop of Caithness. He was a devout churchman and an able statesman. His great work was the erection of a new cathedral at Dornoch and the establishment of a full chapter there, but his long episcopate was beneficial to his diocese in every way. He died in 1245.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, the light of the faithful
and Shepherd of souls,
who didst set blessed Gilbert
to be a bishop in the Church,
that he might
feed thy sheep by his word,
and guide them by his example:
grant us, we pray thee,
to keep the faith which he taught
and to follow in his footsteps;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
the light of the faithful
and shepherd of souls,
you set your servant Gilbert
to be a bishop in the Church,
to feed your sheep by his word
and guide them by his example:
give us grace to keep the faith
which he taught
and to follow in his footsteps;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ASB)

9 APRIL

Dietrich Bonhoeffer, Theologian and Martyr (1945) [6] *Red*

Dietrich Bonhoeffer was born in 1906 into an academic family. Ordained into the Lutheran Church, his theology was influenced by Karl Barth. In 1930 he became a lecturer in systematic theology at Berlin, and quickly showed himself one of the most original Theological thinkers of his day. In 1933 he denounced Hitler on the radio, and two years later, after a time in England, he was forbidden to teach and banned from Berlin. At the outbreak of war he was lecturing in the USA, but returned to Germany to work for the Confessing Church and the political opposition to Hitler. He was drawn into the abortive plot to assassinate Hitler, arrested in April 1943, and after two years, on this day in April 1945, Bonhoeffer was hanged by the Nazi police at Flossenbug concentration camp within sound of the gunfire of the advancing Allied forces.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who by the light of thy Son Jesus
Christ didst guide thy servant
Dietrich Bonhoeffer
through dark and perplexing days:
grant that that same light
may illuminate our paths
in times of doubt and uncertainty,
and give us courage
to confess the faith that is in us
and to stand firm
for what we believe to be right;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Everlasting God,
by the light of your Son Jesus Christ
you guided your servant
Dietrich Bonhoeffer
through dark and perplexing days:
may that same light
illuminate our paths
in times of doubt and uncertainty,
and give us courage
to confess the faith that is in us
and to stand firm
for what we believe to be right;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

10 APRIL
William Law, Priest (1761) [6] *White*

Born at King's Cliffe, Northants, in 1686, William Law was educated at Emmanuel College, Cambridge, and, after ordination as a deacon, became a fellow of the college in 1711. When George I came to the throne in 1714 Law was deprived of his fellowship at Cambridge for refusing to take the Oath of Allegiance. After many years as a private tutor, he retired to his native village, where he organized schools and almshouses, and lived a life of great simplicity and devotion. This is reflected in his writings, and his influence laid the foundation for the religious revival in the 18th century. His "Serious Call to a Devout and Holy Life" has probably had more influence than any other post-Reformation spiritual book except Pilgrims Progress".

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who didst call thy servant
William Law
to a devout and holy life:
grant, we beseech thee,
that by thy spirit of love
and through faithfulness in prayer
we may find the way
to divine knowledge,
and so come to see
the hidden truths of thy glory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you called your servant
William Law
to a devout and holy life:
grant that by your spirit of love
and through faithfulness in prayer
we may find the way
to divine knowledge
and so come to see
the hidden truths of your glory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

11 APRIL

**George Augustus Selwyn, Bishop and Missionary (1878)
[6] *White***

George Augustus Selwyn, the first Bishop of New Zealand, was born in 1809 and educated at Cambridge. He was a Tractarian by conviction, and was made Missionary bishop of New Zealand in 1841, mastering the Maori language during the voyage to his new field of ministry. He exercised a wide-ranging ministry in the area committed to his charge, began missionary work in the Pacific islands, and exerted a formative influence upon the church in the entire region. During the 19-year war between the Maoris and the British colonists, he was able to retain the respect and affection of both sides. He returned to England in 1867, and was appointed Bishop of Lichfield, an office he held until his death in 1878.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
we thank thee for thy servant
George Selwyn,
whom thou didst call
to preach the gospel
to the people of New Zealand:
raise up in this and every land
evangelists and heralds
of thy kingdom,
that thy Church may proclaim
to all the immeasurable riches
of Our Saviour Jesus Christ,
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit
one God, now and for ever.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
we thank you for your servant
George Selwyn,
whom you called
to preach the gospel
to the people of New Zealand:
raise up in this and every land
heralds and evangelists
of your kingdom,
that your Church may make known
the immeasurable riches of our
Saviour Jesus Christ,
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SL)

12 APRIL
William Forbes, Bishop (1634) [6] *White*

Born in Aberdeen in 1585, William Forbes was for a time Professor of logic in the University there. He ministered in Alford and Monymusk, then at St. Nicholas's, Aberdeen. He was a strong High Churchman, who had defended vigorously the Five Articles of Perth, and his strongly patristic Eucharistic theology led him into controversy in Edinburgh, from where he returned to his former charge. King Charles I appointed him first bishop of the newly-created Diocese of Edinburgh in 1633, but he died within a couple of months of his consecration.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Heavenly Father,
who didst illuminate thy servant
William Forbes
with heavenly wisdom:
by the power of thy Holy Spirit
establish his teaching in our hearts,
and grant us grace to follow
his path of virtue;
through Jesus Christ our Lord,
(MEG from R.)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Heavenly Father,
you illuminated your servant
William Forbes
with heavenly wisdom:
by the power of your Holy Spirit
establish his teaching in our hearts,
and guide us to follow
his path of virtue;
through Jesus Christ our Lord,
(MEG from R.)

16 APRIL
Magnus of Orkney, Martyr (c.1116) [6] *Red*

At the end of the 11th Century the Earldom of Orkney was divided between cousins Haakon Paulson and Magnus Erlingsson, one a warlike Viking chief, the other a man of peace. They ruled jointly but uneasily for some years, but eventually Haakon determined to claim sole sovereignty. A council was called for Easter 1116 on the island of Egilsay, but Haakon arrived with a large force, and refused to allow Magnus the options of flight or exile. Magnus then faced his inevitable death heroically and piously, and miracles were recorded rapidly, so that the shrine for his remains, Kirkwall Cathedral, was erected only 20 years after his murder.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God, by whose grace
thy holy martyr Magnus
triumphed over suffering
and was faithful unto death:
move us, we pray thee, by his
example
to deeper devotion and perseverance
in following the teaching
of the Prince of Peace,
thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ;
who now liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
God for ever and ever.

(SA - adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everliving God,
fill us with your Holy Spirit,
and let a love stronger than death
possess our hearts,
the love that enabled Magnus
to rise above the sufferings
of his martyrdom;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(R for St. Vincent – adapted)

17 APRIL

Donnan, Abbot, and Companions, Martyrs (c.617) [6] *Red*

Donnan was an Irish missionary, roughly contemporary with Columba, who worked in Galloway, Argyll and the islands of the Inner Hebrides. He established a monastery on the island of Eigg, where he and 52 companions were butchered around the year AD 617. According to later tradition, they were at Mass when the intruders burst in and made their intentions plain. Donnan begged to be allowed to conclude the service, after which he led his monks across to their refectory where they all perished.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
by whose grace and power
thy holy Martyr Donnan
and his companions
triumphed over suffering and death:
endue us, we beseech thee,
with the same power,
that we may finish our course
in faith, and with them receive
the crown of everlasting life;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
by your grace and power
your holy Martyr Donnan
and his companions
triumphed over suffering and death:
endue us with the same power,
that we may finish our course
in faith, and with them receive
the crown of everlasting life;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(from SPB)

20 APRIL

Maelrubha of Applecross, Abbot (722) [6] *White*

Born near Derry in AD 642, Maelrubha was eighth in direct line of descent from Niall of the Nine Hostages. He entered the monastery at Bangor, but around 671 he followed the Irish practice of “wandering for Christ”.

After two years missionary work around the north-west of Scotland he settled in the remote peninsula of Applecross, where he founded many churches. He died at the advanced age of 80 in the year 722.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God of mercy,
who gavest our fathers
the light of faith
through the preaching
of thy servant Maelrubha:
grant that by the grace of thy Holy
Spirit
we who glory in the Name of Christ
may show forth in our lives
the faith we profess;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God of mercy,
you give the light of faith
to our forefathers
through the preaching of Maelrubha:
by the grace of your Holy Spirit
may we who glory
in the Name of Christ
show forth in our lives
the faith we profess;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R – adapted)

21 APRIL

Anselm of Canterbury, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith (1109) [6] *White*

Born in 1033 in Aosta in the north of Italy, Anselm entered the Benedictine monastery of Le Bec in Normandy under Lanfranc, where he taught theology and quickly advanced in the spiritual life. He was elected abbot in 1078, and succeeded Lanfranc as Archbishop of Canterbury in 1093.

Anselm fought strenuously for the freedom of the Church from secular control against both William II and Henry I, and was twice forced into exile.

He is remembered above all for his theological writings, among them a treatise on the atonement, “Cur Deus Homo?”, and for his deep piety. He died in 1109.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Accept, O Lord,
our thanksgiving
for thy servant Anselm,
who in his life
bore faithful witness to the truth;
and humbly we beseech thee
to raise up in every generation
wise and holy teachers
able to bring forth
out of their treasure
things both old and new;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God,
you gave great gifts
to your servant Anselm
as a pastor and teacher:
grant that we, like him,
may desire you
with our whole heart,
and so desiring,
we may seek you,
and seeking, we may find you;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

23 APRIL

George, Patron of England, Martyr (c.303) [6] *Red*

George was probably a soldier living in Palestine at the beginning of the fourth century. He was martyred at Lydda in about the year 303 or 304, the beginning of the persecutions of Diocletian, and became known through the East as “The Great Martyr”. A church was built at Lydda in his honour soon after those times, and there were churches in England dedicated to him before the Norman conquest.

The story of his slaying the dragon may be due to his being mistaken in iconography for St Michael, himself usually depicted wearing armour; or it may be a mistaken identification with Perseus’s slaying of the sea monster, a myth also associated with Lydda.

George replaced Edward the Confessor as patron saint of England following the Crusades, when returning soldiers brought back a renewed interest in his cult. King Edward III made George patron of the Order of the Garter, which seems finally to have confirmed his position as England’s patron saint.

(Exciting Holiness, 2003, p.165)

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
in whom we rejoice
to celebrate the festival
of thy blessed martyr Saint George:
mercifully grant that by thy grace
we may share
in the steadfastness of his courage,
and with him attain
to thy everlasting victory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God of hosts,
you so kindled the flame of love
in the heart of your servant, George,
that he bore witness to the risen Lord
by his life and by his death:
give us the same faith
and power of love,
that we who rejoice in his triumphs
may come to share with him
the fullness of the resurrection;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

25 APRIL

Mark, Evangelist [4] *Red*

John Mark was a cousin of the apostle Barnabas, and accompanied him and Paul on their first missionary journey, but left them during its course. Paul then refused to take him on the second journey, and this led to his separation from Barnabas, who took Mark with him to Cyprus. The breach was subsequently healed for the New Testament refers to Mark being with Paul in Rome, where he is said also to have been an assistant to Peter, whose teachings he recorded in the Gospel that bears his name, which is generally regarded as the earliest.

Mark's account of the Gospel has a sharpness and an immediacy about it and he does not spare the apostles in noting their weaknesses and lack of understanding that Jesus the Christ would suffer for the world's redemption.

It is likely that Mark was brought up in Jerusalem, and that his mother's house was a Meeting-place for the Church in its earliest days. Tradition ascribes to him the foundation of the Church in Alexandria.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who hast instructed thy holy Church
with the heavenly doctrine
of thy Evangelist Saint Mark:
give us grace, that, being not
like children carried away
with every blast of vain doctrine,
we may be established in the truth
of thy holy Gospel;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who enlightened your holy Church
through the inspired witness
of your evangelist Mark:
grant that we, being firmly grounded
in the truth of the gospel,
may be faithful to its teaching
both in word and deed;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

26 APRIL

Albert Ernest Laurie, Priest (1937) [6] *White*

Born in Edinburgh in 1356, Albert Laurie became a Lay Reader at Old St Paul's Church to finance his theological studies, and continued to serve there, under Canon Mitchell Innes, when ordained in 1890. When Mitchell Innes left to become Sub-Dean of St Mary's Cathedral, Laurie was unanimously elected Rector of Old St Paul's, so that his entire ministry was spent in one church – a ministry marked by personal holiness, faithful teaching and devoted pastoral ministry especially to the poor of the Old Town. His simple love for our Lord draw many others to share that friendship. He died on the Fourth Sunday after Easter, 1937.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O heavenly Father,
Shepherd of thy people,
we give thee thanks
for thy servant Albert Laurie,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of thy flock;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may by thy grace
grow into the stature
of the fullness of
our Lord and Saviour
Jesus Christ;
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(from ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Heavenly Father,
Shepherd of your people,
we thank you
for your servant Albert Laurie,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of your flock;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may by your grace
grow into the stature
of the fullness of
our Lord and Saviour
Jesus Christ;
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(from ECUSA)

29 APRIL

Catherine of Siena, Mystic and Teacher of the Faith (1380)

[6] White

Born at Siena in 1347, Catherine became a tertiary sister of the Dominican Order while still an adolescent, living at home and spending much time in prayer. She was on fire with love for God and for her neighbour, and experienced a long series of raptures and revelations. She worked as a nurse, particularly among plague victims, and visited prisoners condemned to death. A group of people gathered around her, priests and laity, noble and simple, young and old, and helped to spread the influence of her teaching, particularly along religious communities. She worked strenuously for peace among the communes of Italy, and campaigned widely for the ending of the great schism within the Papacy, although to little avail. Her greatness lay in her personal faith and holiness, and in her passionate concern for the salvation of all mankind. She died in 1380.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who by thy Holy Spirit didst raise up
in thy servant Catherine
a contemplative lover
of the sufferings of thy blessed Son
and an ardent servant of thy Church:
grant us thy grace that we too
may be united to Christ
in the mystery of His Passion
and rejoice for ever
in the revelation of his glory;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you so kindled the flame of holy love
in the heart of blessed Catherine of
Siena
as she meditated on the passion
of your Son our Saviour
that she devoted her life
to the poor and the sick,
and to the peace and unity
of your Church:
grant through her prayer
that your people
may be united to Christ
in the mystery of his Passion
and rejoice for ever
in the revelation of his glory;
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God for ever and ever

(R & ECUSA – adapted)

April

1	Gilbert of Caithness, Bishop, 1245	6	White
2	—	—	—
3	—	—	—
4	—	—	—
5	—	—	—
6	—	—	—
7	—	—	—
8	—	—	—
9	Dietrich Bonhoeffer, Theologian and Martyr, 1945	6	Red
10	William Law, Priest, 1761	6	White
11	George Augustus Selwyn, Bishop and Missionary, 1878	6	White
12	William Forbes, Bishop, 1634	6	White
13	—	—	—
14	—	—	—
15	—	—	—
16	Magnus of Orkney, Martyr, c.1116	6	White
17	Donnan, Abbot, and Companions, Martyrs, c.617	6	Red
18	—	—	—
19	—	—	—
20	Maelrubha of Applecross, Abbot, 722	6	White
21	Anselm of Canterbury, Bp and Teacher of the Faith, 1109	6	White
22	—	—	—
23	George, Patron of England, Martyr, c.303	6	Red
24	—	—	—
25	Mark, Evangelist	4	Red
26	Albert Ernest Laurie, Priest, 1937	6	White
27	—	—	—
28	—	—	—
29	Catherine of Siena, Mystic and Teacher of the Faith, 1380	6	White
30	—	—	—